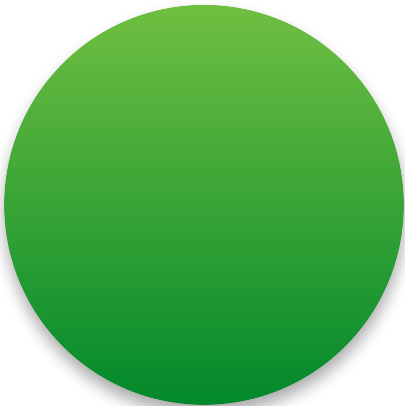
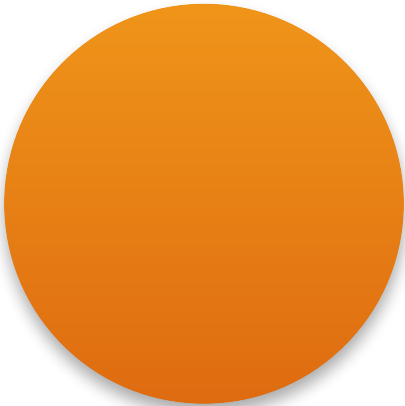
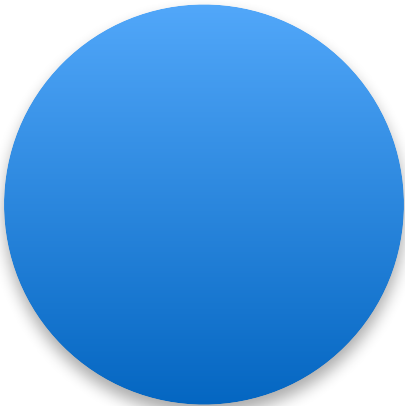
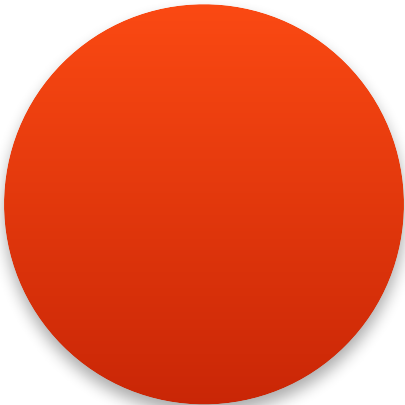














of virtues. Some are based on serious thought and

investigation. Some are based on what our parents told us.

out what we should and should not believe, we need to avoid

We have all gotten our beliefs about the world from a variety

nothing, and test all our beliefs against standard to

taking anything for granted. Instead, we should assume

The start from scratch approach

Some are based on what friends told us. Some are

see which ones we should keep, and which ones we should get

probably based on nothing at all. If we want to really figure

riod

of.

which to keep, and which to discard?

The natural next question is: what is the standard by which we should decide

Here again Descartes gives us an answer.



assent from opinions which are not completely certain and

patiently false. So, the purpose of rejecting my opinion,

it will be enough if I find in each then one reason for

individuals just as fully as I do from those which are

'Reason now leads me to believe that I should hold back my

old world is

What would it mean for you to find in some belief a reason for doubt?

that certain that the belief is true. But what things can we be certain

of? One natural thought is that we can be certain only of those things

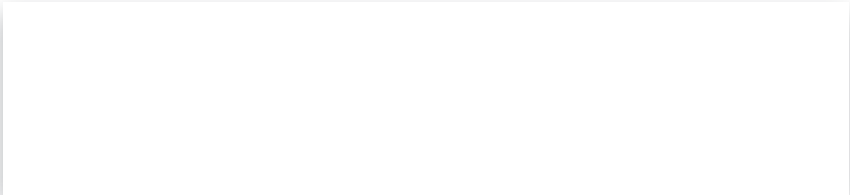
that we can prove.

It seems that to find a reason for doubting a belief would be less

This suggests the following rule of belief:

Let's all believe which we've, but don't have any argument for, basic beliefs.

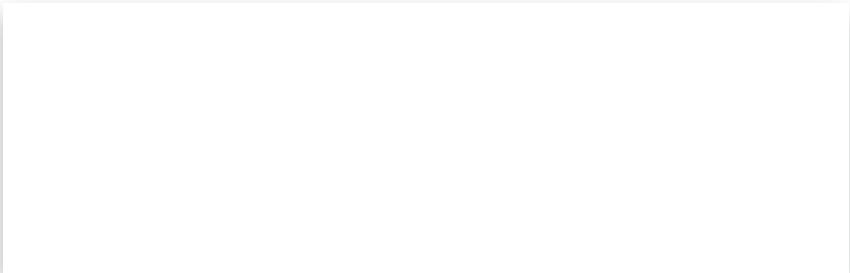
Then the key question seems to be: which basic beliefs should we have?



What should I believe?

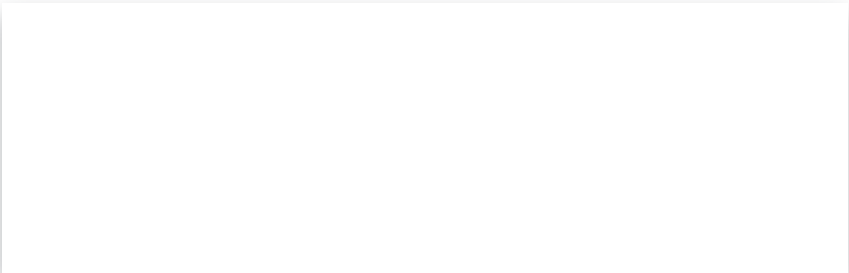
questions.

if you think about it, our initial question really breaks down into two sub-



never die?

What should I find a



When should I discontinue

one of my beliefs?

when you should form a certain

berief.

Positive rules of belief will tell you



when you should not have a certain

Negative rules will tell you

berief.

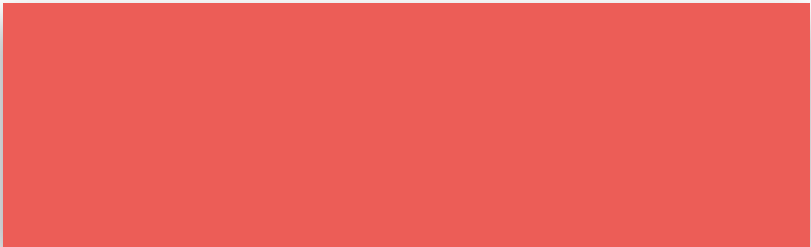


following would seem to be plausible candidates, respectively, for positive

It might at first seem extremely easy to formulate the rules of belief. The

and negative rules of belief.





many cases we don't know whether the claim in question is true or

The problem with these rules of belief is not that they are incorrect; the

the belie.f.)

problem is that in many cases they won't be of much practical use, since in

false. (If we did, there would be no serious question about whether to form







1. For any series x_n , I can

in disingrable from that sense

environment is not as the

2. If I cannot distinguish between two

experience of mine is accurate. (1,2)

series experiences are acute, I

external world. (3,4)

inagine a situation which is

experience with my



which the world is real.

experience say it is.

earranging the text is an

4. If I can't know whether any of my

3. I can never know whether any sense

and I do not know whether there is a

situations, their least know



external world.



acvrate.(1,2*)

situations, their **Islamic** should not believe

about the entire world.

accurate, I should never for beliefs

2*. If I cannot distinguish between two

senise experience of mine is

3*. I should never believe that any

that is real.

4* If I should never believe that any

the entire world. (3*, 4*)

C*. I should never forgive about

The seeming impossibility of replying to Descartes' argument — and hence the

seen by the great German philosopher Kant as a "sandal to philosophy."

seemingly impossible providing a satisfactory profit and an external world — was